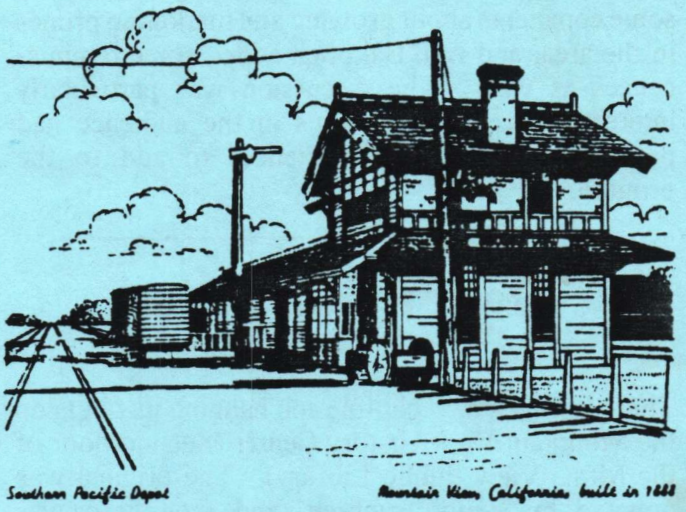
Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Periods of Industry Family Industries in Mountain View
May, 1999 Meeting

The Sunday, May 2, 1999, regular quarterly meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association will be the second in the series on Periods of Industry in Mountain View. In the early part of the twentieth century, Mountain View was the heart of a thriving agricultural area. Farm and Ranch related family businesses were well represented in the area.

The May 2 program will feature two presentations. The first, by Trudy Herrero Odbert, will talk about the Herrero family and *Spanish Sausages*, which the family produced, first in the Whisman area and later in their shop on El Camino Real. The second, by Mario Ambra, will talk about the production of olives and olive products at the family establishment near Rengstorff Avenue. Mario's talk will include several old-time scenes of the East Rengstorff area of Mountain View.

After the program, plan on joining Elizabeth Engberg and Margaret Peterson, our Hospitality co-chairs, for refreshments and good conversation.

Periods of Industry Agriculture In Mountain View
February, 1999, Meeting

The Sunday, February 7, 1999, regular quarterly meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association inaugurated a series of presentation on *Periods of Industry* in Mountain View. This first session presented a panel discussing various aspects of Agricultural, and particularly family farms and ranches in the early part of the twentieth century. The panel was moderated by Wally Erichsen and included John Viscovich, Leo Kalcic, and via video taping, Ralph Faravelli.

John Viscovich talked about the history of cherry growing in the area. Great quantities of cherries were grown near Mountain View, both to supply the local canneries and for shipment to the East.

Leo Kalcic talked about the growing, harvesting and processing apricots. Irrigating, cutting, drying and sulfuring the fruit, all labor intensive activities for a family operation.

Ralph Faravelli had to be away, but he left us with a specially produced video tape. On tape he talked about his parents' truck farming activities in the area.

Roberta Sweeney, from the audience contributed some comments about growing and marketing prunes in the area, and Ann Bakotich added some reminiscences as well. The discussion was particularly interesting, as many persons in the audience had personal insights and experiences to add to the program.

History Center Photograph

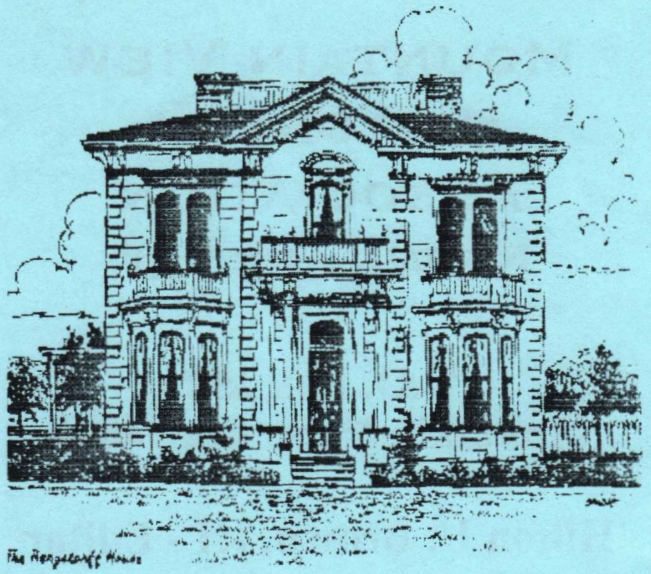
There is now a new photograph hanging just outside the Mountain View History Center (Second floor of the Mtn. View Public Library). The original was donated by Wally Erichsen, and the photo was enlarged and mounted by Lynn Hunton. The enlarged photo is about eight feet long and shows people and soldiers at the electric Mountain View signs at El Camino Real and Castro Street, probably in the mid 1920s. Several of the people have been identified, including members of Wally's family. We need help in identifying more of the people. Its an interesting picture, and worth a look if you are in the vicinity of the library.

Mountain View History Center
Schedule:
Tuesday — Thursday — Saturday
1—5 P.M.
Wednesday
5—9 P.M.

Street Talk

The February **Street Talk Puzzler** was: *Until 1930 Alma Street had a different name. What was it?* The answer — Alma used to be Railroad Avenue and was changed in 1930 so the road would have the same name from Palo Alto to Mountain View.

For this issue the **Street Talk Puzzler** is: *Several streets in Mountain View carry the names of breeds of chickens. What? Where? Why?*



In Commemoration

Beatrice 'Bea' Grass — died at age 85, February 16, 1999. Born in Utah, she was the fifth of nine children of Fred and Emely Davis. The family settled in Aptos. Bea met and married Warren Gras of Santa Cruz and they settled in Mountain View in 1932. Bea and Warren had two children, Alan and Diana, and adopted son Bobby Futch. She is survived by three sisters, Phyllis Silva of San Jose, Vonnie Walters of Watsonville, Renee Foster of Jamestown, her daughter Diane Keenan of Mtn. View, two granddaughters, Terri Foster and Lori Miller and four great grand children. Bea was active in many volunteer activities including Rengsdorff House, the Mtn. View Women's Club and the Mountain View Historical Association.

Executive Committee Meeting

The Executive Committee of the Mountain View Historical Association met March 3, 1999.

Edna Thompson, Chair of the Membership Committee, will take on the additional responsibilities for

Memorials and Remembrances. Wally Erichsen reported that the hard cover *History of Mountain View* is on track for publication before the Mountain View Centennial Celebration.

The Executive Committee approved paying for the enlargement and mounting of the Erichsen photo, now hanging outside the History Center.

The Executive Committee agreed to have reprints produced for selected Association booklets and to request permission to reprint De Witt Hogle's two booklets.

The Treasure's Report is presented elsewhere in this Newsletter, as is the Membership Report.

High-tech Tools for Historical Research
By Candace Bowers

When one thinks of genealogical research, the image that probably comes to mind is that of intimidating stacks of musty, dusty books. Faced with that prospect, it can be difficult to know how to get started on your family history project. Why not use the latest high-tech tools to help you on your way? The Internet can provide a wealth of genealogical information, and getting started might not be as difficult as you think.

A group of volunteers has created a huge, free website that serves as the ideal gateway to genealogical information on the Internet. The USGenWeb Project (http:www.usgenweb.org) is a comprehensive site that provides links to genealogical websites for all 50 states. Each state website is further broken down by county. In addition, USGenWeb sponsors several projects that help you with research that may span state or county lines. This includes an archive of public records; census data; and an ongoing project to transcribe tombstones.

When you choose a state to research, you will find the name of that state's genealogical information coordinator. In turn, you will find a coordinator for each county. Please note that the coordinators are not able to do your family research for you; they are in charge of organizing the information you see on the website.

Each county website provides links to a vast array of information to help you trace your "roots". For example, you may be able to locate volunteers who can do local "look-ups" for you; obituaries; biographies; a list of surnames and their current researchers; old maps; newspaper archives; and information on veterans and battlefields. You might find a forum where you may post inquires; and you might also be able to join an electronic mailing list, where you can communicate with other like-minded researchers via e-mail. (Tip! You might meet some "locals" from your ancestors' home towns.)

One feature that could be especially helpful in your research, is a listing of all cemeteries in a particular county or town. (Remember, each county's website has been compiled by local volunteers, so the level of information at each site will vary.) If you're lucky, you might find that the volunteers have gone so far as to walk the cemeteries and record the information on the tombstones.

If all this information still seems to overwhelm to you, the USGenWeb project has information to help beginning researchers get started.

Private Note

On your Newsletter address label you will find a number following your name. This number is the year through which your dues have been paid. Life Members are indicated by the initials LM and no further dues are required of these dear people. Any questions please call Edna Thompson at 967-3116. Thank you.

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS
Compiled by Barbara Kinchen

100 Years Ago (1899): Eighth grade students were preparing to take the county graduation exams.

Sugar-cured corned beef was selling at 7¢ a pound.

Spring Weather activities: Three sprinkler wagons were in use; baths at the landing were popular: blacksmith shops were crowded with hay presses, rakes and other machinery being repaired and made ready for the predicted bountiful crop; strawberries from the Peter Swall ranch on Charleston Road were being shipped to San Francisco every day.

The Decoration Day race was held around "the Calderon Avenue course." The town baseball team defeated the county "Hayseeds" 17 to 11.

75 years Ago (1924): Mrs. Lillian Peterson, town treasurer for the last ten years, ran for the position of town clerk but was not elected. Incumbent Charles Lake retained the post and A. J. Palmer, town librarian, was voted in as treasurer.

"The wheels of industry are not turned by cranks."

Hung Heung, a Chinese cafe serving chop suey and noodles, was at 638 Villa Street.

Arrested for driving while intoxicated, a young man pleaded guilty to reduced charges of reckless driving, and was sentenced to 90 days in the county jail.

A municipal concert band was organized by Arthur Wright and presented an open-air concert on Castro Street. The 25 local members were joined by other musicians from the peninsula. Local merchants kept stores open for the evening event.

South Shore Port business has been so good that a second boat has been leased and arrangements have been made to lengthen the present boat by a 25 foot middle section.

The town siren will be sounded now at 12 noon instead of at 8 P.M. One reason for the change was "that the dogs would howl less."

Dedication of the new high school on Castro Street was on the afternoon of Memorial Day and conducted by the Grand Parlor of Native Sons of the Golden West.

Fire destroyed the warehouse and 800 tons of prunes belonging to the California Prune and Apricot Association. The $175,000 fire may have been arson. (Location was where the present Police Headquarters building is now.)

The Fire Department has a new engine and a new home. The American-La France fire engine will be housed at the water works on Franklin Street where employees will help take care of fire equipment and start the engine when an alarm comes in. Presently volunteers hear a signal, go to the telephone office for location of the fire and then run to the fire house on Hope Street and start the engine themselves.

50 Years Ago (1949): Most local stores closed Good Friday from 1 to 3 P.M.

Corned beef brisket was 38¢ a pound.

The newly-organized National Guard unit is headquartered in the Adobe Building. This forced the Chamber of Commerce office to move temporarily to 140 Franklin Street, Public Works headquarters.

Bruno Vecchiarelli, Safety Week chairman, was named Man-of-the -Month by the Chamber of Commerce.

Companions of the Forests of America held an apron sale at Growers Hardware.

Highway School pupils hoped to collect 60 tons of newspapers during the annual paper drive.

Louise Schmidt died just short of 30 years on the high school faculty.

Fire destroyed the Campen building on Castro Street housing Hirschbek Music Store and Foster Flower Shop. The flower shop quickly opened for business in the vacant post office building at 102 Castro and the community set up a fund for Mr. Hirschbek.

Calibest Cannery, Stierlin Road and Jackson Street, was ordered closed. The buildings were condemned a year ago and no repairs had been made. Instead, new equipment had been installed for dicing, slicing and shoe-stringing carrots. Up to 150 are employed during the June December season, with a payroll of $100,000.

25 Years Ago (1974): Room rates at El Camino Hospital have been raised to $79 for a private room, $74 for a two-bed room, $70 for a four-bed room, $175 for cardiac care and $230 in intensive care.

The Castro Square Revitalization Committee recommended that an underpass under Central Expressway connect Castro and Moffett Boulevard.

Home Savings and Loan has purchase the Mancini Motors property at El Camino Real and Castro Street. The 52-foot tower with its 9-foot diameter globe will probably be destroyed. This was part of the World's Fair on Treasure Island in 1939 and was trucked to Mountain View by Ugo Mancini in 1940.

Council took action to buy the Sunnyview Club at 266 Escuela Avenue for use as a center for senior citizens. Built about 25 years ago as an Italian-American family social club, it was recently sold as a site for apartments. A restraining order will halt demolition of the building. This will be followed by condemnation and then purchase. Cost for buying and developing the center is estimated to be $650,000.

In April, voters elected the first-ever Mexican-American councilman, Joe Perez, ousted two incumbents and rejected all seven capital improvement bonds totaling $13 million. Selecting a mayor was difficult for the new council - 38 ballots the first meeting, 5 the second, but with the return of an absent member, the third try produced a mayor.

Editor's Exclamation!

A few days ago, Barbara Kinchen, doing her research for her *Old Newspaper Items* column came across the item above about the *Adobe* and the California National Guard. She had barely gotten the words on paper when a letter appeared in the Mountain View Voice from Mr. Joseph de la Fuente providing considerable detail about that event. When a piece of Mountain View History pops up that is a surprise to Barbara Kinchen, its worth a few exclamation points!!!!! Below is an extract from Mr. Fuente's letter.

Adobe Armory
From Joseph de la Fuente

The Adobe Building was the first and only armory in Mountain View. In April, 1949, the State of California leased the building to house the newly organized Battery B, 637th Field Artillery Battalion, California National Guard. The Battalion headquarters was located at 240 N. Second St. in San Jose.

The unit was federally recognized on April 26, 1949. Capt. John S. Vai was the first battery commander. Vai was assistant manager of the Bank of America. Joseph de la Fuente was the administrative assistant (NCO) and Robert R. Sullivan was the unit caretaker (Supply Sergeant). The two NCO's were full time technicians.

The supply room was a small room on the left side of the entrance to the building. It was reinforced with metal landing strips for the protection of the weapons, tools and clothing stored there. The orderly room occupied the old pump building (razed in 1997).

The building was known then as "The Armory" and/or "The Adobe Shack". The Mountain View High School Teen Club used to hold Friday and Saturday night dances there and called it "The Eagle Shack."

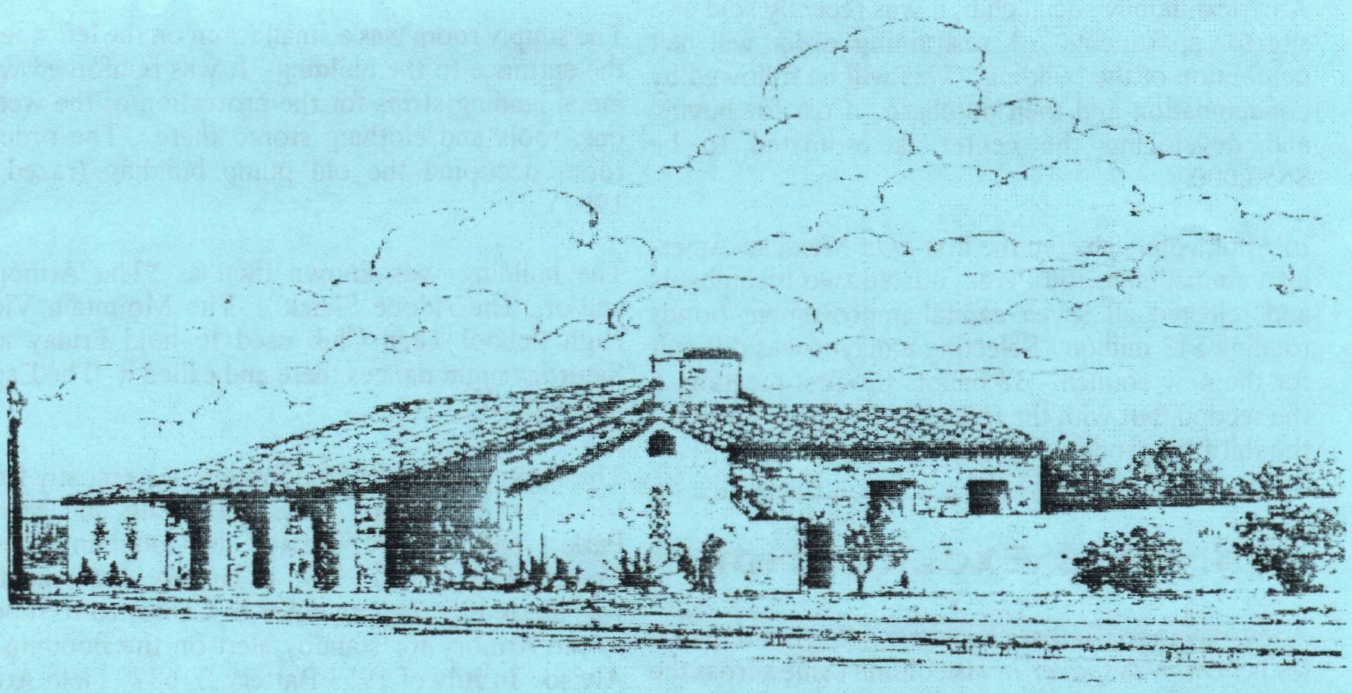
The active members of the Battery were mostly from Mountain View, Los Altos, Palo Alto and Menlo Park. The unit participated in Mountain View's Centennial parade in 1949. In January, 1950 the unit was alerted by the Governor of California to report to the Armory for standby alert on the flooding of Alviso. In July of 1953 Battery B, 637th Field Artillery was relocated to the armory at 251 W. Hedding St. in San Jose. With that the city of Mountain View

lost its one and only National Guard Unit.

This article was extracted from a letter Mr. Joseph de la Fuente wrote to the Mountain View Voice, published April 2, 1999.

Mark Your Calendars

The sixth annual barbecue is early this year! The first Sunday in August is August 1, 1999. Get out your Hi-Liter and shade in **Sunday, August 1, 1999,** for the *Sixth Annual Mountain View Historical Association Barbecue*.



Membership Report
by Edna Thompson

A list of members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available to members from the Chair of the Membership Committee. Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family, and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Life Members	64
Special Member	1
Honored Member	1
Individual & Family Members	212
Total	278

New Members:

Mary Jo Ignoffo – Ronald Dale
Jay Dickson – Tom Frankum

New Life Members

Flora Brown
Frances Churin Mills
Tom Frankum

Life Members

Mario Ambra
Marge Hingsberger Bailey
Godfrey Baumgartner
Dena K. Bonnell
Flora Brown
Hilton Brown
Reynolds Camp
Cliff Del Carlo
Alfred P. Chasuk
Doris Ebere
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Farvelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Carole Fischer
Tom Frankum
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
Ed Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
Norene Hogle
Alice D. Holden
George Holden
Donald M. Holt
Virginia M. Holt
George Jagels
Harold Jarvis
Al Jehning
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Madeline Chargon Malovos
Frances Churin Mills
Eva Mockbee
Gail Urban Moore
LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Mimi Mourkas
Anne G. Nichols
Milan Popovich
John P. Puppo
Patricia J. Reyburn
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Martin J. Spangler
Honor Spitz
J. R. Stafford
Brigitte Stafford
H. Lee Stillens
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson
Sally Moore Taboada
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Denise Williams
Bill Wissell

Association Officers and Board Members

President	Ralph Faravelli
Past President & Social	Wally Erichsen
Vice President & Program	John Viscovich
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	June de Larios
Membership, Memorials And Rememberances	Edna Thompson
Newsletter & Program	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Elizabeth Engberg
" " "	Margaret Peterson
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification/Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

Treasurer's Report
A.J. de Larios

January 1, 1999 – March 31, 1999

Balance 1/1/99		**$ 12,969.56**
Income		
Membership	$ 464.20	
Sales	89.80	
Memorial Fund	125.00	
Interest	3.84	
Total Income		682.84
Expenses		
Administration		327.08
Balance 3/31/99		**$ 13,325.32**
Fund Balances		
Adobe Fund	$ 2,604.32	
Memorial Fund	400.00	
Life Member Fund	6,400.00	
General Fund	3,921.00	
Total Funds		**$ 13,325.32**

Investment

CD $10,000 — 5.40% — Matures 7/99

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

REGULAR MEETING

Sunday, May 2, 1999
2:00 PM
Senior Center - 266 Escuela

A Panel Presentation

Family Industries in Mountain View

Panelists:
Trudy Herrero Odbert
Mario Ambra

MEMBERSHIP: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

TYPE: NEW____ RENEWAL____

Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

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